WAR DEPARTMENT

SKIRMISHERS

GM 1-1

Game Manual

SKIRMISHERS

Skirmishers is a 25mm scale infantry combat game. Any models near this scale may be used; however, it is recommended to use models with a base size of 20mm or smaller, which is approximately the size of a standard US penny. Players control a squad of infantry navigating a ground combat environment. This system is setting agnostic and can be used with any miniatures and maps of the appropriate scale.

CONTENTS

These rules cover a game system overview, infantry rules, and advanced infantry rules.

DISCLAIMER

Skirmishers is a fan-made rules summary. It is freely available under the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International License.

QUESTIONS AND DOWNLOADS

Skirmishers is online at https://skirmishers.jeremylt.org. The *Skirmishers* GitHub repository is at https://github.com/Eudicods/skirmishers. You can post feedback or ask questions as GitHub Issues or email skirmishers@jeremylt.org.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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VERSION

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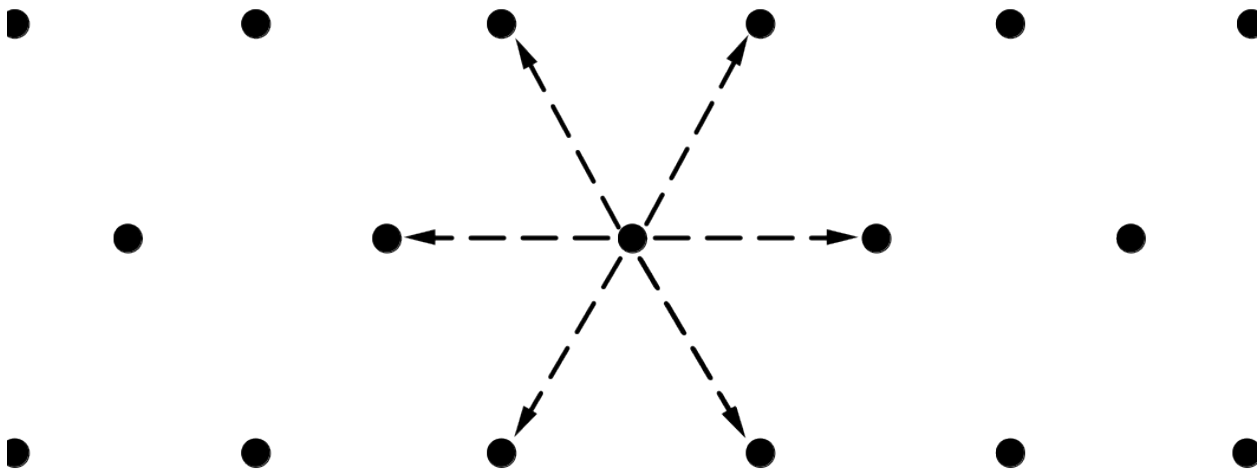
SYSTEM

This section covers the map and basic game loop.

MAP

Skirmishers uses dotted mapsheets. Dots are laid out in a hexagonal pattern, 1 inch apart, and 1 inch on the map represents 2.5 meters. Units occupy a single dot on the mapsheet and may move between adjacent dots.



Sample Map Section

GAME LOOP

Skirmishers uses "I go, you go" (IGOUGO), with each side activating all of their units on their turn. One side randomly is chosen to start, then the the two sides alternate until the game is complete. The basic flow of the game is as follows:

1. Side 1 Activates
   (a) Remove all firing arc tokens for Side 1.
   (b) Move units one at a time. If a unit activates in or moves into an enemy's firing arc, resolve the attack immediately if the enemy unit chooses to fire.
   (c) At the end of each unit's movement, that unit may take a combat action.
   (d) After each unit has moved, resolve any explosives.
2. Side 2 Activates
   (a) Remove all firing arc tokens for Side 2.
   (b) Move units one at a time. If a unit activates in or moves into an enemy's firing arc, resolve the attack immediately if the enemy unit chooses to fire.
   (c) At the end of each unit's movement, that unit may take a combat action.
   (d) After each unit has moved, resolve any explosives.

INFANTRY

The basic unit in *Skirmishers* is the infantry trooper. This section covers the basic rules for standard infantry.

UNIT CARD

The unit card shows the current capabilities of a trooper and tracks damage. A unit card can be formatted in any way so long as it contains all the essential information. Below is a sample unit card for a basic infantry trooper.

Basic Infantry Trooper												
Name												
Number			Skill									
HP	10	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0	Dead
Armor												
AP	8	8	8	8	7	7	6	6	5	4	0	
Mod				+1	+1	+2	+2	+2	+3	+3	-	
Primary				Damage			Long			Short		
Secondary				Damage			Long			Short		
Hand Grenades							Other					
Squad Leader							Leadership					

Basic Infantry Trooper Unit Card

Basic information about the trooper, such as their name, rank, squad position number, and skill level are tracked at the top of the unit card.

Damage to the trooper is tracked in the HP section. HP cells are fully marked off when the trooper takes standard damage or partially marked when the trooper takes bludgeoning damage. The current HP of the trooper is given by the first cell to the right of the lowest fully marked HP cell. For example, if the trooper has HP 9, 7, and 6 marked off and HP 5 partially marked, their current HP is 5.

If the trooper is wearing armor, mark the contiguous block of HP cells protected by the armor in the Armor section. Armor must be destroyed before the corresponding HP cell is marked off.

Total action points (AP) for the trooper are given in the AP section. Use the value in the column corresponding to the trooper's current HP. For example, if the trooper has 5 HP, then they have only 7 AP.

Similarly, the modifier section tracks the current modifier for the trooper's target numbers based upon current HP. For example, if the trooper has 5 HP, then add +2 to all target numbers.

The weapons and equipment section list the primary and secondary weapons the trooper is equipped with, along with their damage values and range brackets. Basic troopers also carry 4 hand grenades and may carry additional equipment. Any rifle automatically comes with a bayonet equipped.

The leadership section lists the squad leader for the trooper and their leadership score. This section contains the information required for morale checks.

WEAPONS AND EQUIPMENT

Troopers carry one primary weapon, one secondary weapon, and 4 hand grenades. All troopers have a helmet and combat knife. The combat knife is assumed to be affixed as a bayonet if the trooper is using some type of rifle or SMG. In some cases, troopers may carry additional equipment.

Primary Weapons

Troopers may use the following primary weapons:

Weapon	Damage	Short Range	Long Range
Auto Pistol*	2	1-7	8-20
Rifle	4	1-27	28-75
SMG*	3	1-17	18-25
Laser Rifle	5	1-17	18-105
Laser SMG*	4	1-25	26-70
Gyrojet Rifle	6	1-57	58-180

Primary Weapons

Note, the auto pistol, SMG, and Laser SMG can fire into the same firing arc multiple times, while the other weapons may only fire into a firing arc once per turn.

Secondary Weapons

Each trooper can have a maximum of 1 secondary weapon. Troopers may use the following ranged secondary weapons:

Weapon	Damage	Short Range	Long Range
Pistol	3	1-7	8-20
Laser Pistol	4	1-12	13-30

Ranged Secondary Weapons

Instead of a ranged secondary weapon, troopers may use the following hand to hand secondary weapons:

Weapon	Damage	Short Range	Long Range
Fists	(AP/2)B	1	-
Blackjack	5B	1	-
Club	1, 4B	1	-
Stun Baton	8B	1	-
Bayonet/Knife	3	1	-
Sword	4	1	-
Vibroblade	5	1	-

Hand to Hand Secondary Weapons

Troopers may use the following explosives:

Weapon	Damage	AP	Ammo	Short Range	Long Range
Satchel Charge	10/5/2	3 or AP	1	AP/2	-
Hand Grenade	6/3/1	AP	4	AP	-

Explosive Weapons

The ammo indicates how many rounds come with the weapon. The damage is given is descending order for the point of detonation, the adjacent dots, the dots 2 away from the detonation, and so on. It takes 1 AP to throw a hand grenade 1 dot, and it takes 2 AP to throw a satchel charge 1 dot.

Armor

Troopers may equip body armor. Body armor protects a number of contiguous cells in the armor section of the unit card. Cells protected by body armor ignore bludgeoning damage. Standard damage destroys the cell of body armor.

Armor Type	Cover-age	AP Cost
Light	2	1
Basic	4	2
Heavy	6	3

Body Armor AP Costs

To equip body armor on a trooper, mark the cells covered by body armor on the unit card. Then, reduce the AP to account for the body armor. For example, with basic body armor, mark 4 contiguous cells as protected by armor and reduce all values in the AP row by 2.

MOVEMENT

Troopers can use a maximum of 8 AP for movement. Troopers move between adjacent points on the map so long as the the new location is on valid terrain and the path between the points does not pass though an impassible obstacle, such as a solid high wall or the truck of a tree.

Movement between adjacent points with no obstructions between them costs 1 AP. Movement between adjacent points with an obstruction between costs 2 AP. Obstructions include objects that are shorter than a person, such as furniture, light vegetation, and low walls.

Troopers may only enter and exit buildings through doorways and windows. Movement between adjacent points that passes through a doorway costs 2 AP. Movement between adjacent points that passes through a window costs 4 AP; however troopers cannot voluntarily fall out of an upper story window or off of a building.

Troopers may use ladders and stairs to change levels in or on a building. Movement between levels costs 3 AP. The trooper stays on the same point when changing levels. The current level of the trooper should be tracked on the unit card or next to the miniature.

Troopers may hide behind solid obstructions, such as furniture and low walls. It costs 1 AP to crouch or go prone. It costs 2 AP to stand from a crouching or prone position. Movement while prone costs double the standard AP.

Movement Type	AP Cost
Standard	1
Obstructed	2
Through door	2
Through window	4
Change level	3
Go prone	1
Stand from prone	2
Move while prone	2x

Movement AP Costs

Special Actions

A unit may take the following special actions during their movement:

Action	AP Cost
Change Weapon	3
Exchange Equipment	6

Special Action AP Costs

A unit can only have one weapon active at a time. It costs 3 AP to change active weapons, including to change to an explosive. A unit automatically switches back to their primary weapon after using the explosive.

Units may exchange weapons or equipment. It costs 6 AP to take a weapon or equipment from another unit, including a dead or unconscious unit. A unit cannot exceed their basic carrying capabilities given on their unit card. A unit may drop weapons or equipment for 0 AP; however, any unit, friendly or enemy, may then pick up the dropped weapon or equipment.

COMBAT

After moving, troopers may use any remaining AP for combat actions, such as establishing a firing arc, engaging in hand to hand combat, or using explosives.

Firing Arcs

A unit may establish a 30 degree, 60 degree, or 150 degree firing arc by paying the corresponding AP. When establishing a firing arc, the vertex of the arc is the dot the unit is standing on and can be oriented in any direction. When an enemy unit enters the firing arc, the friendly unit may fire upon the enemy unit.

Firing Arc Size	AP Cost
30 Degrees	2
60 Degrees	4
150 Degrees	6

Firing Arc AP Costs

Resolving Fire

Note: Players resolve fire during enemy movement, which occurs during your opponent's turn.

If an enemy unit activates in or moves into a firing arc, the unit may choose to fire as long as the unit has line of sight. Draw a straight line between the enemy unit and the firing unit. Obstructions, such as furniture, light vegetation, and low walls, provide cover but do not block line of sight. Impassible obstacles, such as a solid high wall, the truck of a tree, or a unit, block line of sight.

Resolving fire is a 2D6 check with the firing unit's current active weapon. If the roll meets or exceeds the target number, the attack succeeds.

Count the number of dots in the shortest path between the firing unit and target unit to determine the range. If the weapon is in short range, the base target number is 6, and if the weapon is in long range, the base target number is 8.

Add a +1 modifier for each obstruction in the path of fire between the firing unit and the target unit, except for any obstruction between the firing unit's dot and any adjacent dots. Use a -1 modifier if the attacking unit is prone. Add a +1 modifier if the target unit is prone and greater than 1 dot away. Use a -1 modifier if the target unit is prone and 1 dot away.

If the attack succeeds, roll an additional 2D6. This is the initial cell to apply damage in.

Condition	Modifier
Short Range	6
Long Range	8
Cover	+1 per
Attacker Prone	-1
Target Prone	+ 1
Target Prone Adjacent	- 1

Target Number Modifiers

Each weapon has a damage value, which indicates how many cells to mark. Starting with the initial cell, mark off the number of cells given by the damage value of the weapon, skipping any previously marked cells. If a cell is protected by body armor, destroy the body armor instead of marking the cell. The new maximum AP immediately applies to the target unit. If this new AP value meets or exceeds the AP the target unit has spent this turn, the target unit immediately falls prone and can take no further actions.

If the weapon is not automatic (auto pistol, SMG, or laser SMG), then remove the firing arc once the firing is resolved. A unit may decide not to fire if they wish to preserve the firing arc for a future target.

Hand to Hand Combat

It costs 5 AP to make a hand to hand attack. Hand to hand combat is resolved similarly to ranged combat, and the attack is resolved during the target unit's turn. The attacking unit must have a hand to hand weapon active. The attacking unit may use an affixed bayonet or use their active weapon as a club.

Resolving hand to hand combat is a 2D6 check with the attacking unit's current active weapon. If the roll meets or exceeds the target number, the attack succeeds.

The base target number is always 4, and only modifiers for damage on the attacking trooper applies.

Standard damage is applied as above. Starting with the initial cell, mark off the number of cells given by the damage value of the weapon, skipping any previously marked cells. If a cell is protected by body armor, destroy the body armor instead of marking the cell. If the attack does bludgeoning damage, indicated by a #B, apply this damage after any standard damage. Bludgeoning damage partially marks any unmarked cell and fully marks any partially marked cells. Starting with the next cell after the last marked cell for any standard damage, partially mark off the number of cells given by the bludgeoning damage value of the weapon, skipping any previously fully marked cells. If a cell is protected by body armor, the bludgeoning damage is ignored.

Explosives

AP for attacks with explosives are given by the weapon. A thrown grenade costs 1 AP for each dot its thrown, and a thrown satchel charge costs 2 AP for each dot its thrown. Double these AP costs if the attacking unit is prone. A unit cannot set up a firing arc after using an explosive.

A unit can throw a hand grenade or satchel charge down a ladder or stairs any number of levels, or may throw a hand grenade or satchel charge up one level, at a cost of 3 AP. The unit must be standing on the stairwell or ladder to throw the explosive up a level and may be on or adjacent to the stairwell or ladder to throw the explosive down any number of levels.

Explosives are resolved similarly to ranged combat, but the attack is resolved during at the end of the attacking side's turn.

Resolving explosives is a 2D6 check with the firing unit's current active explosive. If the roll meets or exceeds the target number, the attack succeeds.

Hand grenades and satchel charges are always considered to be in short range and the base target number is 6.

Add a +1 modifier for each obstruction in the path of fire between the firing unit and the target dot, except for any obstruction between the firing unit's dot and any adjacent dots. Use a -1 modifier if the attacking unit is prone.

If the target number is met, apply damage starting at the target dot and moving outwards. Roll 2D6 for each trooper in the radius of the explosive to determine where the damage is applied.

If the target number is not met, the explosive scatters. If the line of fire is not obstructed, the explosive scatters from the target point. If the line of fire is obstructed, the explosive scatters from the closest dot along the line of fire that is before the obstruction. Roll 1D6 to determine the scatter direction, identifying one direction to correspond to a result of 1 and proceeding clockwise with the other values. Roll 1D6 to determine the scatter distance. Satchel charges only scatter 1 dot.

If the path of scatter intersects an impassible obstacle, such as a wall, stop the scatter on the last valid dot along the path of scatter. Then apply the damage as above from the scatter point.

ADVANCED INFANTRY

This section covers advanced rules for infantry, including advanced movement, crew served weapons, advanced explosives, and morale checks.

CREWED WEAPONS

Troopers may carry a crewed weapon in place of their primary weapon.

Weapon	Damage	Crew	Short Range	Long Range
Light Machine Gun	5	0	1-30	31-84
Medium Machine Gun	6	1	1-30	31-84
Heavy Machine Gun	7	2	1-36	37-110
Semi-Portable Laser	11	1	1-80	81-240
Heavy Semi-Portable Laser	14	2	1-100	101-280

Crewed Weapons

The crew indicates how many additional troopers must be nearby to setup the weapon. For example, a semi-portable laser requires one extra trooper to be adjacent to the trooper carrying the weapon during setup. Each trooper involved must use 4 AP to setup or break down a crewed weapon.

Action	AP Cost
Setup Weapon	4 (per)
Tear Down Weapon	4 (per)
Takeover Weapon	6

Crewed Weapon AP Costs

If the trooper controlling a crew served weapon is killed or abandons the weapon, any other trooper, friendly or enemy, may take over the crew served weapon. To take over a crew served weapon, a trooper must enter the dot with the weapon and spend 6 AP to switch active weapons.

Crew served weapons set up firing arcs like rifles and pistols; however crew served weapons may only use 60 degree firing arcs. Fire is resolved the same way as with standard weapons. Crew served weapons are always automatic weapons, so the firing arc is not removed after the firing is resolved.

ADVANCED EXPLOSIVES

Troopers may use the following advanced explosives:

Weapon	Damage	AP	Ammo	Short Range	Long Range
Light Anti-Tank Weapon	7/3/1	4	1	1-22	23-80
Rocket Launcher	8/4/2	5	2	1-44	45-108
Anti-Tank Missile	13/6/3/1	5	1	1-54	55-96
Grenade Launcher	4/2/1	3	4	1-10	11-24
Auto-Grenade Launcher	3/2/1	4	4	1-22	23-50
Recoilless Rifle	4/2/1	4	2	1-36	37-70

Advanced Explosive Weapons

The ammo indicates how many rounds come with the weapon. The damage is given is descending order for the point of detonation, the adjacent dots, the dots 2 away from the detonation, and so on.

Rocket launchers, anti-tank missiles, and recoilless rifles are primary weapons. Light anti-tank weapons are secondary weapons.

A trooper must be using a rifle or SMG as their primary weapon to use a grenade launcher. The launcher takes the place of a secondary weapon, but it is mounted under the body of the rifle or SMG. A trooper does not have to pay AP to switch between their primary weapon and a launcher. An auto-grenade launcher is a separate weapon and cannot be mounted under a primary weapon in this fashion.

In the Other section of the unit card, a trooper may carry extra ammunition, doubling the ammunition available for any explosive weapon.

Advanced explosive weapons resolve in the same way as hand grenades and satchel charges, but these weapons only scatter 1 dot.

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